

presentation in June 2012 where skydivers, abseilers, and mountain bikers wore the glasses and live streamed their point of view to a Google+ Hangout, which was also shown live at the Google I/O.

Google Glasses have also been compared to Steve Mann's EyeTap. An EyeTap is also a type of wearable computing gear for one eye invented by Steve Mann in 1980s. The design allows the user's eye to operate as both a monitor and a camera. The first prototype consisted of a computer in a backpack wired up to a camera and its viewfinder which in turn was jerry-rigged to a helmet. With time, the technology evolved and the size of the device shrunk. The current version consists of an eyepiece that mediates the reality, a keypad with which the user can interface with the EyeTap and a small processor which can be attached to almost anything, even a WiFi device for pulling up data from the Internet. Delving into the technology behind this amazing gear, we find that an EyeTap uses something called a "beam splitter" to send the same image to both the eye and a camera. The camera then digitizes that reflected image and sends it to a computer, which processes it. The result of all this processing is data that is sent to a projector that will then be overlayed over the scene that you are viewing



Steve Mann with EyeTap

Interactive eyemaker Vuzix will also reveal their competitor to Google Glasses- Smart Glass M100, in CES 2013. The Vuzix eyepatch will have Android IceCream Sandwich and a 720p camera along with Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and head-tracking sensors. You can take stills, capture video (with playback and picture viewing options), answer the phone with a visual address book, read emails and texts and run various AR applications. This "modernized monocle" is supposedly iOS and Android compatible. Vuzix, which spe-